

Jacoby Two Notrump

A 2NT response to a Major sit opening promises at least 4-card support and at least opening hand strength. It is absolutely forcing to game.

Opener's second bid describes her hand further:

4 of the Major shows a minimum featureless hand

3NT shows extra strength and a 5-card trump suit

3 of the Major shows extra strength and a 6+ card trump suit

3 of any other suit shows shortness (singleton or void)

4 of any other suit shows a second 5-card suit

Splinter Bids

A double-jump-shift as a response to partner's opening 1 of a Major suit is a Splinter bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least four card support for the Major, and a singleton or void in the "splintered" suit. It is absolutely forcing to game.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥6

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥2

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦9

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 5♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦4

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠7

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥2

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7 4 2

♥ 10 2

♦ Q 6 3

♣ 10 8 7

♠ K Q J

♥ K Q J 8 4

♦ 9 4

♣ J 6 5



♠ A 10 6 5

♥ 7 6

♦ K 8 7 5

♣ A 3 2

♠ 3

♥ A 9 5 3

♦ A J 10 2

♣ K Q 9 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♥6

SOUTH's 3♠ bid, a double-jump, is a Splinter bid. It shows game-forcing strength, at least four cards in partner's suit, and a singleton or void in the Splintered suit.

NORTH has just 14 points and the ♠ shortness in SOUTH's hand doesn't improve her hand since she had just one ♠ loser anyway. She signs off in 4♥.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 3
 ♥ A 9 5 3
 ♦ A J 10 2
 ♣ K Q 9 4

♠ A Q J 5

♥ 10 7

♦ 9 6 5 3

♣ 8 7 3



♠ 7 6 4

♥ K Q J 8 4

♦ K 4

♣ A 6 5

♠ K 10 9 8 2

♥ 6 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ J 10 2

This is a companion hand to Deal 13.

EAST has 14 points, the same strength she had in Deal 13. But what a difference. This time WEST's ♠ shortness complements her hand very well. She bids 4♣ to show her Control, and after WEST shows the ♦ A she uses Blackwood to make sure WEST also has the trump Ace.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1♥	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♦	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♥	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by East			
Lead: ♥2			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 8 6 4 3

♥ 5 3 2

♦ 9 2

♣ A 9 2

♠ K Q

♥ A K 8

♦ 7 5 4 3

♣ J 10 6 5



♠ J 9 2

♥ 9 4

♦ A K Q 10 6

♣ 8 7 4

♠ A 7 5

♥ Q J 10 7 6

♦ J 8

♣ K Q 3

NORTH has 13 points and good 3-card support for SOUTH's 1♥ opening bid. But he should not bid 2NT since that bid promises 4+ cards in support. North must still insure they reach game, so he bids a forcing 2♣.

When SOUTH next says 2NT NORTH can jump to 4♥.

NOTE: if you used Jacoby 2NT and reached the 4♥ game, give yourself credit anyway.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦9			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 3
 ♥ K J 9 6 5 2
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ K Q 5

♠ A 10 7 6 4
 ♥ Q
 ♦ 10 7 4 3
 ♣ 10 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J
 ♥ A 8 7 3
 ♦ 6 2
 ♣ A J 9 2

♠ 9 8 5 2
 ♥ 10 4
 ♦ A 9 8 5
 ♣ 8 6 4

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♣	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♥	
All Pass			
5♥ by West			
Lead: ♦4			

WEST bids 3♠ to show a strong hand with a singleton ♠.

After EAST shows her first-round ♣ control WEST decides he will bid slam if EAST has three Aces.

When Blackwood reveals just two Aces in EAST, WEST stops at 5♥.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 5 4 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A 10 5

♣ A 9 7

♠ 6

♥ A K 9 7 2

♦ 8 7

♣ K Q 8 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 7 3

♥ 10 4

♦ K 4 3 2

♣ 10 4 3

♠ A Q 9

♥ Q J 8 3

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ J 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♠ 7

NORTH bids 4 ♣ after SOUTH's Jacoby 2NT. The reason for this bid is just to describe her hand as having a side 5-card ♣ suit. NORTH knows the eventual contract will be some level of ♥s.

SOUTH doesn't have a strong hand, but he would show ♦ control at this time if he had the Ace. He isn't strong enough to go past game to show the ♠ A, so he just bids 4 ♥.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 8 4
♥ K 8 7 5
♦ A J 4
♣ 6 4

♠ 3 2

♥ A Q 10 6

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ J 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9 7 6 5

♥ J 9

♦ K 7 5

♣ A Q

♠ 10

♥ 4 3 2

♦ Q 10 3

♣ K 10 9 8 3 2

WEST should not be tempted to use Jacoby 2NT with this hand. There are only 12 points, and the Limit Raise is a perfect way to show a 12 point support hand.

EAST has more than enough strength to bid game after WEST's limit raise. If WEST had mistakenly used a Jacoby 2NT response, EAST would probably have tried to reach slam, and perhaps gotten too high.

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥ 2